SS-C-661A
January 11, 1974
SUPERSEDING
Fed. Spec. SS-C-661
July 15, 1953

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

CRAYON, MARKING

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 This specification covers requirements for genuine and processed soapstone crayon.

1.2 Classification. The marking crayon shall be of the following composition, as specified (see 6.2):

Composition I - Genuine soapstone crayon.
Composition II - Processed soapstone crayon.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENT

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specification:

PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.

Federal Standard:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specification:

MIL-P-116 - Preservation, Methods Of.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

FSC 7510

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2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Association, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material.

3.1.1 Composition I. Composition I marking crayon shall be cut from genuine untreated soapstone (steatite). The crayon shall be of uniform strength and free from foreign matters (see 3.2).

3.1.2 Composition II. Composition II marking crayon shall be made of soft, white grade talc and suitable binding materials to assure compliance with the performance requirements of 3.2.

3.2 Performance. The crayon shall be capable of making easily distinguishable white marks on bare, painted, dry, moist or oily metal, fabrics, wood or ceramics, when tested as specified in 4.4.1. The crayon shall not break, when tested as specified in 4.4.2.

3.3 Shape. The crayon shall be rectangular in cross section. Both ends may be cut at 90 degrees with respect to the two adjacent sides, or one end may be so cut and the other end sharpened to chisel edge, with the taper not to exceed 1/2 inch in length.

3.4 Dimensions. The dimensions of the crayons shall be as specified in table I. A plus tolerance of 1/16 inch for the width and thickness dimensions is permitted, with no minus tolerance.

TABLE I. Dimensions (in inches)

Length (minimum)	Width	Thickness
4	1/2	3/16

3.5 Workmanship. The crayon shall be free from defects which may impair serviceability.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 Size of lot. All crayon presented for inspection at one time shall be considered a lot for the purpose of examination and test.

4.2.2 Sampling for inspection. Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise specified.

4.2.3 Sampling for visual and dimensional examination. Boxes of crayons shall be taken at random from each lot in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The sample unit shall be one box of crayons, except that ten (10) pieces of crayon, taken at random, from each box, shall be examined as specified in 4.3.1 and table II. The Inspection Level shall be S-4, with an Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) of 4.0 percent defective.

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4.2.4 Sampling for preparation for delivery requirements. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table III. For examination of interior packaging the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery, selected at random just prior to the closing operations. Defects of closure listed shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 defects per hundred units.

4.2.5 Sampling for test. Boxes of crayon shall be taken at random from each lot in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The sample unit shall be one box of crayons. The crayons shall be tested as specified in 4.4. The inspection level shall be S-2, with an AQL of 2.5 percent defective.

4.3 Examination.

4.3.1 Visual and dimensional examination. Samples taken in accordance with 4.2.3 shall be examined for defects listed in table II. Any crayon having one or more defects shall be rejected. If the number of defective units in the sample exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, the entire lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

TABLE II. Visual and dimensional examination

Examine	Defects
Material	Not as specified (see 3.1).
Shape	Not as specified (see 3.3).
Dimensions	Not as specified (see 3.4 and table I).
Workmanship	Not in accordance with 3.5.

4.3.2 Examination of preparation for delivery. Samples selected in accordance with 4.2.4 shall be examined for defects listed in table III to determine that packaging, packing, and marking requirements conform to the requirements of section 5. Any sample having one or more defects shall be rejected. If the number of defective units in the sample exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, the entire lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

TABLE III. Classification of preparation for delivery defects

Examine	Defects
Markings	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Material	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, inadequate stapling, or distortion of container.
Contents	Quantity per container is more or less than required. Gross weight exceeds requirements of the box specification.

4.4 Tests. Samples obtained in accordance with 4.2.5 shall be subjected to the following tests. Failure of one or more pieces of crayons in a sample box to pass any test shall render the box defective. If the number of defective boxes of crayons exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, the entire lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

4.4.1 Writing test. Select one piece of crayon at random from each sample box. Unless otherwise specified, write one five letter word and make a few sharp turns, reversals, and circles on fabric, on dry and bare wood, and on ceramics.

4.4.2 Strength test. Select one piece of crayon at random from each sample box. Place crayon perpendicular across two horizontal parallel rods 1/4 inch in diameter and 3 inches apart. Using a 1/4 inch diameter rod, the test load shall be applied in a vertical direction at the midpoint of the crayon. Gradually apply and increase test load up to 3 pounds and then maintain maximum test load for 10 seconds. Check for compliance with 3.2.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. One-hundred and forty-four crayons shall be packaged in accordance with method III of MIL-P-116.

5.1.2 Level C. The crayons shall be packaged to insure protection during shipment and safe delivery to destination.

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5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Twelve packages of crayons as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in a box conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather resistant. Close, water-proof seal and strap the boxes in accordance with the appendix to PPP-B-636.

5.2.2 Level B. Twelve packages of crayons as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in a box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. Closure of boxes shall be in accordance with method II of the appendix to PPP-B-636.

5.2.3 Level C. The crayons packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed to comply with the National Motor Freight Classification rules or the Uniform Freight Classification rules, as applicable.

5.3 Marking. In addition to any special markings required by the contract or order, all marking shall be in accordance with 5.3.1 or 5.3.2, as specified (see 6.2).

5.3.1 Civil agencies. Marking shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 Military agencies. Marking shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The crayons covered in this specification are intended primarily for marking metals, fabrics, wood and ceramics.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Composition required (see 1.2).
(c) Level of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(d) Any special marking required (see 5.3).

DOD HAS WAIVED COORINATION INTEREST

Preparing Activity:

CSA-FSS

User Activity:

Army - GL

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